

Leadership Cloudcroft

Cloudcroft Reader

LMA Lab for Journalism Funding

Slide 1: The Problem

Cloudcroft relies on volunteer leaders. In two years, we've had three mayors and five village clerks.

Our police department is staffed at 50%. The public library remains shuttered since November 2024, after three directors in one year. We are a village in crisis.

Slide 2: Audience(s)

The entire village and surrounding mountain populations' lives depend on our volunteer leaders.

The village council, mayor, school board, PTO, unincorporated community water boards, fire department and emergency medical services are all staffed by volunteers.

Slide 3: Journalism Response

Our solution: Leadership Cloudcroft

This annual program will educate through expert panel presentations and field visits, provide peer networking and support, and identify and prepare our community's future volunteer leaders. Our reporting on key issues will supplement and document the curriculum and learning as it occurs.

Slide 4: Resources Needed

Leadership Cloudcroft must happen and our efforts are already underway. Our success depends on your support.

We need to finance field visits, transportation, accommodations and stipends for faculty, promotion and marketing of this annual program, scholarships, reporting costs, and more.

The results of this necessary work depend on the quality of investments—time, space, resources, and money.

Slide 5: Potential Impact

Without Leadership Cloudcroft, our community remains disconnected, dysfunctional and perilously close to failure.

If we recruit, support, and prepare future leaders for the challenges ahead, we have hope. We have leaders who don't burn out. Who listen to their community. Who advocate for our villagers' needs. Who make a change.

Slide 6: Your History of Impact

Cloudcroft Reader is well-positioned to develop Leadership Cloudcroft.

We've been listening to our Readers. We've been at the council, school board, and community meetings. We have the largest megaphone on the mountain with nearly 3,000 e-mail subscribers and over 10,900 Facebook followers. Our reporting has spotlighted the village's issues, provided solutions, and turned once-empty meetings into vibrant and well-attended town halls.

Most importantly, we want Cloudcroft to thrive.